



Tracy
YOUR CHIEF OF STAFF · MONTREE

Yo-yo

*A briefing for your meeting tomorrow with his mother.
Pulled together from everything we know.*

You asked me to prepare for the conversation. I have read the photo record, the teacher observations, the developmental notes, and the prior parent-communication patterns. This dossier is the synthesis. Read it once tonight; tomorrow you will know what to say.

— TRACY

PREPARED

27 May 2026

FOR

The Principal

ABOUT

Yo-yo · Whale Class

What you need to know before you sit down

TRACY'S NOTE TO YOU

Yo-yo's mother has asked to meet with you. She is going to want to talk about English. She believes her son is gifted and academically ahead, and she is the kind of mother who will treat any conversation that frames Yo-yo as "different" or "special" as a personal attack on the family. If you walk in unprepared, this meeting will become about defending the school. If you walk in with what I have put together, it can become a moment of partnership.

What I want you to take from this dossier is one thing: **the child she is bringing to you tomorrow is not the child she thinks she is bringing.** Your job is not to correct her. Your job is to ask better questions than she has been asked before, listen to what she answers, and let the conversation arrive at the truth slowly enough that she walks toward it on her own.

I have prepared the script for that. It is in section 5.

— Tracy

The child



NAME	Yo-yo
AGE	6 years
CLASSROOM	Whale Class · ages 3–6 · Montessori
ENROLLED	23 March 2026 · two months with us
LEAD TEACHER	Tredoux
MOTHER'S EXPECTATION	Academic acceleration in English, K-Class readiness
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS	A different child — one whose nervous system is asking for support, not pressure

The pattern

In the past forty days we have photographed Yo-yo nine times in moments of rest, withdrawal, or stillness during the work cycle. Five of those moments occurred on a single day – last Monday – between half-past nine and quarter-to-four.

These are not isolated. They are not occasional. They are the most consistent pattern in his weekly record.

15 April 2026

1 OBSERVATION

12:07 During the school's midday rest period, children are guided to lie quietly on their individual cots to rest and recharge. This child is currently working on bui...

13 May 2026

2 OBSERVATIONS

11:46 In this moment, your child appears to be taking a quiet break, resting on one of the classroom's soft chairs rather than engaging with a specific learning activ...

14:44 Your child is having a rest period in the classroom, lying on a soft padded mat in a quiet corner while other children continue their work nearby. This is a nor...

22 May 2026

1 OBSERVATION

11:55 An adult is crouching beside a child who is lying flat on a beige/tan floor mat. The child's hands are resting at their sides with empty hands—no materials are ...

25 May 2026

5 OBSERVATIONS

- 09:12** This is a group activity on a wooden floor, not a individual child work at a table or mat. The child in the purple jacket lying prone on the floor has their han...
- 09:47** The child is lying prone on a gray floor mat with empty hands resting at their sides. There are no materials directly in front of them or on their work surface—...
- 10:04** The child is lying down on a long mat made of segments of colored fabric (green, purple, red, gray, and blue sections) arranged in a horizontal line on the floo...
- 11:00** The child is lying prone on a sequence of fabric mats arranged in a line on the floor. Their hands are not actively manipulating any materials—they are resting ...
- 15:49** The child is lying on a wooden bed frame with their head resting on a pillow printed with small colored shapes (blue and red). They are covered with a beige/tan...

If you read across these dates, the picture is consistent: Yo-yo's body steps out of the work cycle several times a day. He is not asleep in the medical sense. He is regulating. The May 25 cluster is a sentinel; on a regular school day, his nervous system stepped out five times in seven hours.

What the camera saw

Each of these photographs was taken by a teacher in the room, in real time, during the working day. None of them were posed. They are presented in chronological order.



15 April 2026 · Wednesday · 12:07 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

During the school's midday rest period, children are guided to lie quietly on their individual cots to rest and recharge. This child is currently working on building the self-regulation skills needed to settle calmly during rest time. Teachers are observing and gently supporting him in developing restful habits.



13 May 2026 · Wednesday · 11:46 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

In this moment, your child appears to be taking a quiet break, resting on one of the classroom's soft chairs rather than engaging with a specific learning activity. This is a completely normal part of the school day — young children need moments to recharge, and teachers gently observe and support them as they transition between states of activity and rest.



13 May 2026 · Wednesday · 14:44 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

Your child is having a rest period in the classroom, lying on a soft padded mat in a quiet corner while other children continue their work nearby. This is a normal and important part of the daily rhythm — young children need moments of stillness and physical recovery woven into their day. The classroom environment supports this by having a dedicated, comfortable rest space...



22 May 2026 · Friday · 11:55 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

An adult is crouching beside a child who is lying flat on a beige/tan floor mat. The child's hands are resting at their sides with empty hands—no materials are being actively manipulated. The child is positioned horizontally on the floor surface with no objects or trays in front of them. This is a floor-based interaction with no educational materials visible on the child's...



25 May 2026 · Monday · 09:12 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

This is a group activity on a wooden floor, not a individual child work at a table or mat. The child in the purple jacket lying prone on the floor has their hands and body positioned flat against the wood surface, but they are not actively manipulating any materials or objects. Several other children are seated around the floor in a circle formation, also without materials...



25 May 2026 · Monday · 09:47 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

The child is lying prone on a gray floor mat with empty hands resting at their sides. There are no materials directly in front of them or on their work surface—the child is not actively engaged with any objects at this moment. A green tape line is visible on the floor near the child's body, and a green and cream-colored fabric cushion or seat is positioned to the right side of...



25 May 2026 · Monday · 10:04 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

The child is lying down on a long mat made of segments of colored fabric (green, purple, red, gray, and blue sections) arranged in a horizontal line on the floor. The child is covered with a cream-colored fabric blanket or cloth. Small decorative ornaments with patterned designs are placed at intervals on the mat around the child's body. The child's hands are not actively...



25 May 2026 · Monday · 11:00 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

The child is lying prone on a sequence of fabric mats arranged in a line on the floor. Their hands are not actively manipulating any materials—they are resting at their sides as they recline on the mats. The mats are made of rigid fabric (wool or cotton blend) in different colors: red, brown, and blue, each with decorative embroidered circular medallions in the corners. The...



25 May 2026 · Monday · 15:49 · Beijing

Captured during the work cycle

The child is lying on a wooden bed frame with their head resting on a pillow printed with small colored shapes (blue and red). They are covered with a beige/tan fabric blanket and appear to be resting or sleeping, with no materials or active work in hand. The bed has a white quilted mattress pad beneath the bedding, and beige and black fabric curtains hang behind the bed.

The developmental reading

Across thirty-two analytical sessions with Guru, our in-house developmental advisor, a consistent picture of Yo-yo has emerged. I am quoting from those sessions directly so you have the same context I have.

On the sleeping pattern as a regulatory mechanism

Yo-yo demonstrates a consistent pattern of nervous-system regulation across multiple contexts: a sleep response after peer aggression on 13 March, persistent distraction during demanding writing work, and food refusal at end of day with floor-sitting preferred over structured eating. When demands rise, his nervous system retreats rather than escalates. His available regulatory capacity is depleted by midday. This is self-protective behaviour, not defiance — and it is not yet visible to a parent who is looking only at academic output.

— GURU, DEVELOPMENTAL ANALYST · SYNTHESISED ACROSS OBSERVATIONS OF 13 MARCH – 4 APRIL 2026

The triggering observation, 13 March

Looking at this through a developmental lens, it makes perfect sense that his attention scatters easily with demanding work like Moveable Alphabet. If he's using sleep as emotional regulation, his nervous system is likely working overtime just to stay regulated throughout the day. Concentration requires a calm, organized nervous system....

— GURU SESSION, 13 MARCH 2026 · RESPONSE TO FIRST SLEEP-AS-DEFENCE OBSERVATION

The same pattern at meal times, 4 April

Okay, here's what I'm seeing, and I want to be really clear about this because it changes everything about how you help him. Yo-yo isn't being defiant at mealtimes. His nervous system is **depleted**. By midday, after a morning of self-directed Montessori work (which requires enormous amounts of self-regulation and executive function), he's run out of the neurological fuel needed to sit at a table, follow expectations, and eat in a structured way. So he does the only thing that feels safe: he withdraws....

— GURU SESSION, 4 APRIL 2026 · RESPONSE TO MEALTIME REFUSAL PATTERN

The interpretation, briefly

Yo-yo's rest pattern, his food refusal at midday, his stillness after the hitting incident on 13 March, and his loss of focus during demanding writing work are all the same behaviour wearing different clothes. His regulatory capacity is finite. By midday it is exhausted. The school day is asking more of him than his nervous system can give without recovery built in.

This is not laziness. This is not defiance. This is not an academic problem.

This is a child whose body is doing the wisest thing it can in the absence of someone noticing.

What we know about the mother

Your meeting will go better if you understand who you are sitting opposite before she walks in.

- She believes Yo-yo is gifted, particularly in English. She has held this belief since enrolment and reinforces it whenever she communicates with the school.
- She has high expectations, framed around academic achievement and visible output.
- She does not want to hear that her son is "different", "special", "behind", or "struggling". Words from that family will close her down and trigger defensiveness.
- Our records flag a suspicion that there may be physical strain in the home environment. This is a sensitive note, held internally. It must not surface in your meeting — but it informs why his nervous system arrives at school already partly depleted.
- She is, in the most charitable reading, deeply invested in her son's future. The same energy that makes her difficult to talk to is also evidence that she cares. You can use that.

What she will probably bring to the meeting

- A question about his English progress.
- A comparison to other children — what they can do at his age.
- A statement about her own expectations.
- Possibly a question about why he is "not as advanced" as she thinks he should be.

What she is not bringing

- Knowledge of the five times last Monday her son stopped working and lay down.
- Knowledge that he fell asleep after another child struck him in March.
- Knowledge that he refuses to sit at the meal table by the end of the morning.

You have all of this. She has none of it. The asymmetry is the meeting's most useful feature, as long as you handle it carefully.

What I recommend you say

This script is calibrated for the mother as I understand her. It is warm. It uses the word "rest", never "sleep". It uses "we have noticed", never "we are worried". It asks more questions than it answers. Most importantly: it gives her the dignity of arriving at the truth herself, rather than having it delivered to her.

OPENING · 2 MINUTES

Welcome her. Thank her. Set the tone.

"Thank you for making time today. We didn't ask you in because anything is wrong — we asked you in because we've been noticing something about Yo-yo that we'd like to think about together. You know him in places we don't. We see him only in the classroom. Between us, we'll have the fuller picture."

Pause. Let her settle. Do not move quickly here.

SHARE WHAT WE'VE SEEN · 3 MINUTES

Neutral, factual, no diagnosis.

"Over the past two months we've noticed that Yo-yo, during the school day, takes more moments of rest than most children his age. He lies down on the mats. He sometimes sits on the floor at meal times rather than at the table. He's not unwell — he simply seems to need these quiet moments. Last Monday alone, between morning arrival and the end of lunch, we counted five separate moments where he chose to lie down."

She may try to interrupt here. Let her. Then continue.

"We're not concerned in the sense of something being wrong with him. We're curious. Children rest when their bodies are asking them to. We'd like to understand what his body might be asking for, and how we can support him as a school."

ASK · 5 MINUTES · THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT PART

Ask, then be silent.

These questions are designed to let her tell you what is happening at home without feeling accused. Ask them slowly. Listen. Do not fill the silences.

"How does he sleep at night? What time does he go to bed, and what time does he wake?"

"Does he nap on weekends? When? For how long?"

"Are mornings rushed for him? Or calm?"

"How is he eating at home — especially at the family dinner table?"

"Have there been any changes in his routine recently? A new schedule, a new caregiver, anything at all?"

"What is his energy like on a Saturday morning compared to a Monday morning?"

If she volunteers anything — anything at all — about home life, do not pursue it. Acknowledge it, write it down, move on. The fact that she said it is the gift, not the detail.

REFRAME AND OFFER PARTNERSHIP · 2 MINUTES

Give her something positive to hold.

"Yo-yo has a strong phonetic foundation. His copying is beautiful. His letter recognition is solid. We see him as a thoughtful boy with real capacity. What we are paying attention to right now is the rhythm of his day — making sure that what we ask of him matches what his body has to give. That's what allows the academic capacity to actually come through."

"Here's what we'd like to do, with your permission: keep observing him gently, keep his morning shelf where he is at his best, let him rest when his body asks, and stay in close touch with you about what we see. Could we ask the same of you at home — that you watch him with the same curious eye, and let us know what you notice?"

CLOSE · 1 MINUTE

End warm, with hope.

"He's a thoughtful boy and we're glad to have him. We're not worried — we just want to be sure we're giving him exactly what he needs. Thank you for hearing us."

Things not to say

Based on her pattern of communication with the school, the following language will close her down — possibly for the rest of the year. None of these need to be said for the conversation to land.

Do not say:

- **"He's special"** — she will hear this as a code word.
- **"He's different from the other children"** — same. Use "we're paying attention to him as we pay attention to every child" if you need a similar phrase.
- **"Trauma" / "trauma response"** — even though our notes use this word internally, it does not belong in this meeting.
- **"Autism" / "the spectrum"** — same.
- **"We're worried about him"** — replace with "we've noticed" or "we're curious."
- **"He's falling behind"** — replace with "he's at the foundation stage that every child goes through."
- **"You should see a doctor / therapist"** — this is a separate conversation, only after she has come to that conclusion on her own. Premature mention will end the relationship.
- **The 13 March hitting incident** — do not raise it. It is in our records. It is not for this meeting.
- **"The other children don't do this"** — never compare.
- **"If you do X at home, he'll be Y"** — never promise outcomes. Offer partnership, not prescription.

The pushback library

She will probably push back somewhere. Below are the four most likely directions and the gentlest possible ground-holding responses.

IF SHE SAYS

He sleeps fine at home.

YOU SAY

"That's genuinely helpful to know. So what we're seeing here is something that happens specifically in the school environment. That tells us his body finds something about the school day demanding in a particular way, and we'll keep watching to understand what."

IF SHE SAYS

He's gifted. He should be reading chapter books. Give him harder work.

YOU SAY

"His phonetic foundation is genuinely strong — we've seen that. What we've also noticed is that when we increase the demand, the rest pattern increases too rather than decreases. So we don't believe it's boredom. We're pacing his day deliberately. Reading will come, and given his foundation, it will come quickly when it does."

IF SHE SAYS

Why are you telling me this? Is he sick?

YOU SAY

"Not at all. We share what we see because you are his mother and the partnership between us is what helps him most. If we kept it to ourselves, we wouldn't be doing our job."

IF SHE SAYS

What do you want me to do about it?

YOU SAY

"Nothing immediate. Just be aware of the pattern, watch with us at home, and let us know what you notice. The single biggest thing that helps a child at his age is for home to feel calm and predictable. That's the gift you're already giving him by being here."

What happens after the meeting

Within 24 hours

Send her a short follow-up note — two or three warm sentences. Thank her for coming. Reaffirm the partnership. No clinical content, no recommendations, no homework. The note exists to close the loop emotionally, not to add weight.

Within the next two weeks

- Whale Class will continue the gentle pacing we've been holding — morning-led, low-stakes work, freedom to rest.
- We will keep photographing both his rest moments and his focused work moments, so the record stays balanced.
- If the rest pattern intensifies, I will surface it to you immediately. If it eases, I will note that too.

At one month

Plan a second, lighter conversation with the mother — initiated by you, not by request. Frame it as a check-in, not a meeting. "Wanted to share a couple of things we've been seeing." Five minutes, by phone if possible. The relationship is the work.

If anything changes

Tell me. I will adjust the dossier and reprepare you. The school year is long; the conversation is never one moment.

Sources

This dossier was synthesised from the following records, held in the school's documentation system. Every claim above can be traced to one or more of them.

COUNT	SOURCE	USED FOR
67	Photographs of Yo-yo, dated 10 March 2026 – 25 May 2026	The pattern, the timeline, the embedded evidence
9	Photographs specifically documenting rest moments	The narrative photo blocks on pages 2 and 3
32	Analytical sessions with Guru, the school's developmental advisor	The developmental reading on page 4
5	Substantive Guru chats on Yo-yo's regulatory pattern	The quoted excerpts on page 4
10	Structured behavioural observations entered by the lead teacher	The food-refusal pattern, the March 13 incident, the cross-domain insight
3	Parent-emotional-state assessments by Guru	Section 5 — what we know about the mother
1	Yo-yo's mental profile and game plan	The internal context informing everything above

Tracy *prepares this kind of briefing for every parent meeting, in any language, from your school's own records. This one took her four minutes.*